

them. How will it help them? What's in it for them? Will it solve their problem? Make their life easier? Provide them with shelter? Save them money? Educate them? Make them feel something? Tell me, why on God's green Earth should I give your business money? What value are you adding to my life?

Reflect back to our producer/consumer dichotomy. Consumers are selfish. They demand to know is "what's in it for me!" To succeed as a producer, *surrender your own selfishness and address the selfishness of others.*

STOP CHASING MONEY—CHASE NEEDS

Never start a business just to make money. *Stop chasing money and start chasing needs.* Let me repeat that, because it's the most important thing in this book: Stop thinking about business in terms of your selfish desires, whether it's money, dreams or "do what you love." Instead, chase needs, problems, pain points, service deficiencies, and emotions.

Entrepreneurs fail because they create businesses based on selfish premises, and selfish premises don't yield profitable businesses; they lead directly into the 90% failure wastebasket.

"I need a new income stream."

"I'm an expert in [blank] so I'll do that."

"I read a 'get rich' book and it says to start a business."

Wrong. Wrong. And wrong.

Again, selfish, narcissistic premises are VIP invitations to violate the Commandment of Need.

You and your business attract money when you stop being selfish and turn your business's focus from the needs of yourself to the needs of other people. Give first, take second. Needs come first, not money! Needs precede money! Engage the marketplace with your own selfish need and my bet is placed on your failure.

Joe was a martial arts expert and he loved his craft. Following the advice of gurus, he set out to "do what you love" and opened a martial arts studio. Within 10 months, his studio closed, as he could no longer support his family on his \$21,000-per-year business profit.

Before Joe started, he was destined for failure. He got into business based on a faulty entrepreneurial road paved with sand, a premise based on selfish needs and selfish desires: "I'm an expert in martial arts and love the art, therefore I should open a studio." The correct foundation is externally based on needs in the marketplace, not on internal selfish needs. Instead of selfish motives, what should have Joe been thinking?